

COMPLIANCE RESPONSE MATRIX

Multi-Jurisdiction Data Deletion Requests

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Classification	Confidential
Jurisdictions	Rwanda DPL · GDPR (EU) · CCPA/CPRA (California)

1 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

On 12 May 2026, ShopGhana received simultaneous data deletion requests from three customers in different legal jurisdictions. Each request triggers a distinct set of obligations under a different national or regional data protection regime. This matrix analyses each case, identifies applicable rights and exemptions, specifies required actions and timelines, and provides draft response letters.

Cases at a Glance

Customer	Law	Summary
Abena Accra, Ghana	Rwanda DPL Law 058/2021	Straightforward full deletion. No active orders or disputes. Financial records retained 5–7 years. 30-day response window. Lowest penalty exposure of the three.
Lukas Berlin, Germany	GDPR Article 17	Deletion with tax-law exemption. Invoice records held 10 years under §147 Abgabenordnung. Highest regulatory risk. 1-month response window.
Maria Los Angeles, CA	CCPA/CPRA California	Partial deletion hold — active return dispute. Opt-out of data sale processed separately within 15 business days. 45-day deletion window.

Key Risk: Penalty Asymmetry

Rwanda's DPL carries a maximum fine of ~USD 3,500 or 1% of global turnover. The CCPA imposes up to USD 7,500 per intentional violation. The GDPR allows fines of up to EUR 20,000,000 or 4% of total global annual turnover — a categorically different level of exposure. Compliance investment should reflect that asymmetry.

Regulatory Philosophy

GDPR	Privacy as a fundamental human right. Processing is presumptively impermissible without a lawful basis. Most rights-protective of the three frameworks.
Rwanda DPL	GDPR-influenced rights-based framework with strong controller and processor obligations.
CCPA/CPRA	Processing is presumptively permissible; the consumer may opt out after the fact.

2 LEGAL ANALYSIS

2.1 Customer A: Abena (Accra, Ghana)

Applicable Law: Rwanda Data Protection Law, Law No. 058/2021 of 13/10/2021

Jurisdictional note: Abena is located in Ghana, where the domestic law would ordinarily be the Ghana Data Protection Act 2012 (Act 843). Rwanda's DPL is applied here as directed for this exercise. Rwanda's law is more closely aligned with the GDPR than Ghana's, and illustrates the direction of travel for data protection legislation across the continent.

Right to Deletion

Abena has a clear right to deletion under Rwanda's DPL. The law grants data subjects the right to request erasure of their personal data where it is no longer necessary for the purpose for which it was collected, where consent is withdrawn with no other legal basis remaining, or where the data has been processed unlawfully.

Her case is the least complicated of the three. Her account is three years old, her last purchase was eight months ago, and there are no open orders or disputes. The original purpose of processing her data was to facilitate transactions. That purpose has run its course, and her request to withdraw is unambiguous.

ShopGhana's Obligations

- Acknowledge the request and verify Abena's identity before proceeding.
- Delete all personal data: account profile, contact information, login credentials, purchase history, browsing behaviour, and marketing preferences.
- Notify all third-party processors of the erasure obligation and obtain written confirmation of their deletion.
- Retain financial and transaction records only to the extent required by applicable tax regulations, held securely with a documented expiry date and no secondary use.
- Respond in writing within 30 days confirming what was deleted and, if anything was retained, the legal basis for doing so.

Data Retention

Financial transaction records may be retained for 5–7 years for tax and accounting compliance purposes. That is the extent of legitimate retention. The data cannot be used to reconstruct Abena's profile or inform any future processing.

Response Deadline

Response required within 30 days of receipt. If Abena is dissatisfied, she may appeal to Rwanda's Data Protection and Privacy Office (dpo.gov.rw) within 30 days of receiving ShopGhana's response. The supervisory authority then has 60 days to respond to the appeal.

2.2 Customer B: Lukas (Berlin, Germany)

Applicable Law: EU General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), Article 17

Right to Erasure

Lukas has a valid right to erasure under GDPR Article 17, which explicitly grants data subjects the right to have their personal data deleted. He may rely on the ground that the data is no longer necessary for the purpose for which it was collected, given that his purchase has been completed and delivered.

There is a significant caveat. His purchase two weeks ago generated invoice and transaction records that German tax law (§147 of the Abgabenordnung) requires to be retained for ten years. GDPR Article 17(3)(b) explicitly exempts data whose retention is required to comply with a legal obligation under EU or member state law. Lukas will exist in ShopGhana's accounting records until 2036. That is not a failure of his erasure right — it is the designed limit of it.

Data to Delete vs. Data to Retain

Delete	Retain — Legal Obligation
Account profile, login credentials, saved addresses, stored payment methods. Browsing and behavioural data, marketing preferences, analytics identifiers. Stored communications with ShopGhana. <i>Formal erasure instructions must be issued to all third-party processors: analytics, marketing, logistics, payment, and retargeting partners.</i>	Invoices and transaction records: order amounts, dates, product descriptions, VAT records. Basis: German Tax Code §147 Abgabenordnung — 10-year mandatory retention. Deletion date: 2036. Records held securely, access-restricted to tax compliance only.

Required Steps

- Acknowledge receipt in writing immediately.
- Verify identity via confirmed account email address.
- Conduct a full data-mapping exercise before beginning deletion — CRM, analytics, email platform, payment processor, logistics partner, retargeting service.
- Complete deletion of all non-exempt data.
- Issue formal erasure instructions to all third-party processors and log confirmations.
- Send written confirmation within 30 days: what was deleted, what was retained, legal basis for retention, and right to complain to the supervisory authority.

1-Month GDPR Deadline — Non-Compliance Risk

GDPR Article 12(3) requires a response within one calendar month. Extension by a further two months is permitted for complex cases, provided Lukas is notified within the initial period. Failure to respond without valid justification exposes ShopGhana to fines of up to EUR 20,000,000 or 4% of total global annual turnover under GDPR Article 83.

GDPR Article 37 requires designation of a Data Protection Officer where an organisation systematically monitors EU data subjects at scale. If ShopGhana does not yet have a designated DPO, handling this request in full compliance will be difficult in practice. That gap should be addressed as a priority.

2.3 Customer C: Maria (Los Angeles, California)

Applicable Law: *California Consumer Privacy Act (CCPA)* / *California Privacy Rights Act (CPRA)*

Rights Under CCPA/CPRA

Right	Provision
Right to Delete	Section 1798.105 — Maria may request deletion of personal information ShopGhana holds about her, subject to defined exceptions.
Right to Opt-Out of Sale/Sharing	Section 1798.120 — Maria may direct ShopGhana to stop selling or sharing her personal information. Effective immediately; not contingent on the deletion request.
Right to Know	Section 1798.110 — Maria is entitled to disclosure of the categories of personal information collected, purposes of collection, and categories of third parties with whom it has been shared.
Right to Non-Discrimination	Section 1798.125 — ShopGhana may not penalise Maria for exercising any of these rights.

Can the Deletion Request Be Processed Immediately?

Not in full — and it is worth explaining why in honest rather than merely defensive terms. Maria has an active return dispute filed 20 days ago. A full deletion right now would erase the order records, purchase confirmation, communications, and payment references that document her original transaction — the same records Maria would need if her return dispute escalated. Deleting them immediately would be more likely to harm her interests than protect them.

CCPA Section 1798.105(d)(1) provides the applicable exception: a business may retain personal information necessary to complete a transaction or resolve a dispute initiated by the consumer. The exception is narrow — it covers only data directly tied to the dispute. Everything else should be deleted immediately.

Processing the Opt-Out of Sale Request

The opt-out request is straightforward and must be acted on separately from the deletion hold. Under Section 1798.120, it must be honoured within 15 business days of receipt. ShopGhana must update its internal systems, instruct all third parties to cease sale or sharing of Maria's data, and confirm compliance to Maria in writing by that deadline.

Response Deadlines

Deletion request: respond within 45 days of receiving a verifiable consumer request (extendable by a further 45 days with written notice). Opt-out of sale: honoured within 15 business days of receipt, confirmed in writing. Maria's right to file a complaint with the California Privacy Protection Agency (cpa.ca.gov) must also be disclosed.

CCPA's framing of the opt-out right reflects a different regulatory architecture than the GDPR. Under GDPR, a lawful basis for processing would have been required upfront. Under CCPA, processing and sharing are presumptively permitted and the consumer may opt out after the fact.

3 COMPLIANCE RESPONSE MATRIX

The table below compares the key features of each applicable legal framework across six dimensions.

Element	Rwanda DPL(Law 058/2021)	GDPR (EU)Article 17	CCPA / CPRA(California)
Right to Deletion Exists?	Yes. Data subjects may request erasure where data is no longer necessary, consent is withdrawn, or processing is unlawful.	Yes. GDPR Article 17 — the "right to be forgotten." One of the most explicit erasure rights in global data protection law.	Yes. CCPA Section 1798.105 grants consumers the right to request deletion, subject to defined exceptions.
Exemptions / Conditions	Retention permitted for: legal obligation compliance; public interest; exercise or defence of legal claims; purposes that legitimately override the data subject's interest.	Article 17(3) exemptions: legal obligation compliance; freedom of expression; public health; archiving and research in the public interest; legal claims. Tax-retention exemption under national law is most commonly invoked.	Section 1798.105(d) exceptions: completing a transaction; resolving a consumer-initiated dispute; security and fraud prevention; legal obligation compliance. The dispute exception is most practically significant for e-commerce.
Response Deadline	30 days from receipt, with written or electronic response required.	1 calendar month from receipt. Extendable by 2 months for complex requests, with notification within the initial month.	45 days from receipt of a verifiable consumer request. Extendable by a further 45 days with written notice. Opt-out of sale: 15 business days.
Penalties for Non-Compliance	Administrative fine RWF 2,000,000–5,000,000 (~USD 1,400–3,500) or up to 1% of global annual turnover. Criminal liability up to 5% of annual turnover.	Up to EUR 20,000,000 or 4% of total global annual turnover, whichever is higher (GDPR Article 83). Most significant penalty regime of the three.	USD 2,500 per unintentional violation; USD 7,500 per intentional violation (CCPA Section 1798.155). Aggregate exposure can be substantial at scale.
Consent Requirements	Processing requires consent or another lawful basis. Withdrawal of consent triggers erasure where consent was the sole basis.	Processing must be grounded in one of six lawful bases under Article 6. Consent withdrawal triggers the erasure right where it was the sole basis.	CCPA does not use a consent-first model for standard processing. Opt-in consent required only for sale of data of consumers under 16 and for sensitive personal information beyond primary purposes (CPRA).
Underlying Philosophy	Rights-based, drafted with reference to GDPR. Broader extraterritorial scope; processor liability nearly equivalent to controller liability; mandatory pre-processing registration.	Privacy as a fundamental human right (EU Charter, Article 8). Processing presumptively impermissible without a lawful basis. Most rights-protective of the three.	Privacy as a consumer marketplace entitlement. Processing presumptively permissible; consumer may opt out. Framework originated

			from a California ballot initiative.
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Data Retention Summary

Customer	Data to Delete	Data to Retain	Legal Basis	Retention Period
Abena Rwanda DPL	Account profile, credentials, contact details, purchase history, browsing data, marketing preferences.	Transaction and order records, payment confirmation references.	Applicable tax and financial reporting obligations.	5–7 years from transaction date.
Lukas GDPR	Account profile, credentials, saved addresses, stored payment methods, behavioural data, marketing preferences.	Invoices and transaction records: order amounts, dates, product descriptions, VAT records.	German Tax Law, §147 Abgabenordnung — mandatory 10-year retention.	10 years from end of financial year of transaction (until 2036).
Maria CCPA/CPRA	Marketing preferences, browsing history, recommendations, non-essential profile data (delete immediately). Full profile after dispute resolves.	Order details, purchase records, correspondence, payment references, return address.	CCPA Section 1798.105(d)(1): exception for resolving a dispute initiated by the consumer.	Duration of active dispute only. Full deletion within 45 days of dispute resolution.

4 ACTION TIMELINES

Abena — Rwanda DPL (30-day window from 12 May 2026)

Deadline	Required Action
12 May (Day 1)	Send written acknowledgement of receipt. Initiate identity verification.
14 May (Day 3)	Confirm identity. Verify no outstanding obligations or legal holds on account data.
17 May (Day 5)	Begin technical deletion across all systems: CRM, email platform, marketing tools, analytics.
19 May (Day 7)	Issue erasure instructions to all third-party processors. Request written confirmation of deletion.
22–26 May	Receive and log third-party deletion confirmations.
1 June (Day 20)	Segregate retained financial records. Apply access restrictions and document expiry date (5–7 years from transaction date).
11 June (Day 30)	Send final written confirmation to Abena: what was deleted, what was retained, and legal basis. Request complete.

Lukas — GDPR (1-month window from 12 May 2026)

Deadline	Required Action
12 May (Day 1)	Send written acknowledgement confirming receipt of the Article 17 erasure request.
14 May (Day 3)	Verify identity via confirmed account email address.
17–19 May (Days 5–7)	Data-mapping exercise: identify all systems holding Lukas's data before beginning deletion (CRM, analytics, marketing, payment processor, logistics, retargeting).
22 May (Day 10)	Begin deletion of account profile, credentials, behavioural data, marketing records, and stored payment methods.
24 May (Day 12)	Issue formal erasure instructions to all third-party processors and service providers.
26 May (Day 14)	Segregate invoice and transaction records. Apply 10-year retention flag; deletion date 2036. Store securely, access-restricted.
2 June (Day 21)	Receive and log third-party deletion confirmations.
11 June (Day 30)	Send formal written response to Lukas: what was deleted; what was retained and the legal basis; right to complain to the competent supervisory authority.

Maria — CCPA/CPRA (45-day window + 15-day opt-out from 12 May 2026)

Deadline	Required Action
12 May (Day 1)	Acknowledge both requests (deletion and opt-out) in writing. Begin identity verification as a verifiable consumer request.
12–27 May (Days 1–15)	Process opt-out of sale and sharing: update all internal systems; instruct third parties to cease sale/sharing. Confirm in writing by Day 15 at the latest.
14–17 May (Days 3–5)	Assess the active return dispute: identify exactly which data must be preserved. Document the scope of the hold.
22 May (Day 10)	Delete all non-dispute data: marketing preferences, browsing history, recommendations, non-essential profile fields.
22 May (Day 10)	Send written response to Maria: confirm opt-out is processed; explain deletion hold with precise legal basis (Section 1798.105(d)(1)); provide expected timeline for full deletion upon dispute resolution.
Upon dispute resolution	Initiate full deletion of all remaining dispute-related data. Target: within 45 days of resolution.
Final confirmation	Send written notice confirming complete deletion. Log entire process in CCPA/CPRA request records with dates and actions taken.

5 DRAFT RESPONSE LETTERS

The following letters are drafted for ShopGhana's use in responding to each customer. They are written to be jurisdiction-appropriate in tone and content: clear and empathetic for Abena under Rwanda's DPL; formal and precise for Lukas under GDPR; and structured around California's specific disclosure obligations for Maria.

Letter A — Abena (Rwanda DPL)

Reference: REF-001

Subject: Data Deletion Request — Response

Dear Abena,

We acknowledge receipt of your request dated 12 May 2026 to delete your account and all associated personal information. We have verified your identity and confirmed that there are no outstanding orders or disputes on your account.

In accordance with Rwanda's Data Protection Law (Law No. 058/2021), we have initiated the deletion of your personal data from our systems. This includes your account profile, contact information, login credentials, purchase history, browsing data, and marketing preferences. We are also instructing our third-party service providers to erase your data from their systems accordingly.

Certain financial transaction records will be retained for a limited period in compliance with applicable tax and accounting obligations. This retention is strictly limited to what is legally required. The records are held securely, accessible only for compliance purposes, and will be deleted at the end of the mandatory retention period.

Deletion of all other data will be fully completed within 30 days of this notice, after which we will send final written confirmation. If you are dissatisfied with our response, you have the right to appeal to Rwanda's Data Protection and Privacy Office at dpo.gov.rw within 30 days of receiving this letter.

Yours sincerely,

[Name]

Data Protection Officer, ShopGhana
privacy@shopghana.com

Letter B — Lukas (GDPR)

Reference: REF-002

Subject: GDPR Right to Erasure Request — Response

Dear Mr. [Surname],

We acknowledge receipt of your request for erasure of personal data under GDPR Article 17, received on 12 May 2026. We are processing your request in full accordance with our obligations under the General Data Protection Regulation.

Data to be deleted: Your account profile, login credentials, saved addresses, stored payment methods, browsing and behavioural data, and marketing preferences will be permanently deleted from our systems within

30 days. We will simultaneously instruct all third-party processors — including analytics, marketing, and logistics service providers — to erase your personal data from their systems.

Data retained under legal obligation: In compliance with §147 of the German Tax Code (Abgabenordnung), we are required to retain commercial records and invoices for a period of 10 years. This obligation takes precedence over the erasure right for this specific category of data, as provided under GDPR Article 17(3)(b). These records are held securely, accessible only for tax compliance purposes, and will be permanently deleted upon expiry of the statutory retention period.

Your request will be processed in full within 30 days of this notice. You have the right to lodge a complaint with the competent data protection supervisory authority in your federal state if you consider that the processing of your personal data does not comply with the GDPR.

Yours sincerely,

[Name]

Data Protection Officer, ShopGhana
privacy@shopghana.com

Letter C — Maria (CCPA/CPRA)

Reference: REF-003

Subject: California Privacy Rights Requests — Response

Dear Ms. [Surname],

We acknowledge receipt of two privacy rights requests submitted on 12 May 2026: a request to delete your personal information, and a request to stop the sale of your personal information to third parties. We respond to each below.

Opt-out of sale and sharing: Your request to opt out of the sale and sharing of your personal information is effective as of 12 May 2026. We are notifying all relevant third parties to cease any sale or sharing of your information. Written confirmation of full implementation will be provided within 15 business days. This opt-out remains in effect indefinitely unless you instruct us otherwise.

Deletion request: We are unable to process a complete deletion of your personal data at this time. Our records reflect an active return dispute that you filed approximately 20 days ago. Under California Civil Code Section 1798.105(d)(1), we are permitted to retain personal information necessary to resolve a dispute that you have initiated. Deleting the relevant records before the dispute is resolved would prevent us from processing your return and would be contrary to your own interests in the outcome.

We have, however, already deleted all personal data not required for dispute resolution, including marketing preferences, browsing history, and product recommendation data. The remaining data will be deleted in full upon resolution of the dispute, and you will be notified promptly when that process is initiated.

Under CCPA/CPRA, you are also entitled to: the right to know what categories of personal information we hold about you and how it is used; the right not to be discriminated against for exercising these privacy rights; and the right to submit a complaint to the California Privacy Protection Agency (CPPA) at coppa.ca.gov if you are not satisfied with our response.

For any questions, please contact our Privacy Team at privacy@shopghana.com.

Yours sincerely,

[Name]

Data Protection Officer, ShopGhana

privacy@shopghana.com

6 NOTE ON PRACTICAL IMPLEMENTATION

Receiving three simultaneous deletion requests from three different jurisdictions is not a hypothetical scenario — it is a foreseeable operational reality for any e-commerce platform with a global customer base. The legal analysis in this matrix is only as useful as the infrastructure behind it.

The practical gaps that would prevent ShopGhana from handling these requests well are predictable: no unified request intake system, incomplete data mapping across third-party tools, no designated DPO for GDPR purposes, and no pre-drafted response templates. None of these are complicated problems to solve, but they need to be solved before the next request arrives rather than after it.

Priority Actions

- Designate a Data Protection Officer (required for GDPR compliance at scale).
- Build a unified deletion-request intake system that routes by jurisdiction automatically.
- Complete a full data-mapping exercise across all third-party tools and processors.
- Pre-draft jurisdiction-specific response templates and obtain legal review.
- Establish documented retention schedules with automated expiry flags in each system.

Priority by Regulatory Risk

Of the three cases above, Lukas's carries the highest regulatory risk given the GDPR penalty framework. Abena's is the most straightforward. Maria's is the most procedurally nuanced. All three are manageable with the right processes in place. Without them, a single missed GDPR deadline has the potential to be the most consequential compliance failure in the company's history.